

THE EDIT ABROAD

Tamarindo

The Luxury Packing Guide

GUANACASTE · SURF BREAKS · JUNGLE · PACIFIC SUNSETS

WELCOME TO THE EDIT

Tamarindo — Where the Jungle Meets the Pacific

Tamarindo is one of Central America's most beautiful beach towns — golden sand, world-class surf, howler monkeys at dawn, and Pacific sunsets that stop traffic.

The Guanacaste dry season (December–April) brings reliably clear skies, warm water, and the kind of outdoor life that resets everything.

Packing here is about function and beauty in equal measure. You need fabrics that survive humidity, salt, and sand — and still look effortlessly put-together at the open-air restaurant watching the sun drop into the Pacific.

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The Pacific sunset is free. The right outfit makes it unforgettable.

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YOUR DESTINATIONS

TAMARINDO	SURF BREAK	JUNGLE	PACIFIC
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BEST TIME TO VISIT

Dry season (December–April) is ideal — sunny, warm, and perfect for the beach. Shoulder seasons (May, November) can be beautiful with occasional afternoon rain.

DEC–JAN Dry, perfect, busy	FEB–MAR Peak dry season, ideal	APRIL Hot, dry, uncrowded
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Her Edit — Tamarindo Wardrobe

Surf, jungle, sunsets, and barefoot luxury

CLOTHING — WHAT TO PACK

DAYWEAR

Bikini sets × 3
Quality one-piece swimsuit × 1
Linen or cotton sundress × 3
Board shorts or surf shorts × 1
Linen wide-leg trousers × 1

EVENING & LAYERS

Sheer maxi coverup × 1
Linen blouse (loose) × 2
Lightweight joggers (jungle tours) × 1
Rashguard (surfing) × 1
Slip dress (sunset evenings) × 1

SHOES

Sport sandal (Birkenstock or Teva) — jungle paths and beach walks
Flip flop — beach only, waterproof
White sneaker or trail shoe — forest tours and zip-lining
Strappy flat sandal — sunset dinners and beach restaurants

ACCESSORIES

HEADWEAR & JEWELLERY

Wide-brim sun hat (UV50+ and waterproof)
Waterproof or resin jewellery only
Sarong (multipurpose: coverup, blanket, bag wrap)

BAGS & EYEWEAR

Waterproof dry bag (for beach and water)
Small crossbody (town errands)
Quality polarised sunglasses (wrap style)

HER TAMARINDO STYLE PRINCIPLE

The palette: tropical green, sunset orange, ocean blue, sandy white.
Function first — salt, humidity, and sand destroy delicate fabrics and fine jewellery.
The sunset ritual: every evening, the whole town faces west. Dress for the occasion.

OUTFIT INSPIRATION

BEACH & SURF



Bikini, rashguard,
sport sandal, sun hat

TOWN & CAFÉ



Linen sundress,
flip flop, crossbody

SUNSET DINNER



Slip dress,
strappy flat, simple jewellery

His Edit — Tamarindo Wardrobe

Surf, explore, relax, repeat

CLOTHING — WHAT TO PACK

TOPS & TROUSERS

Surf or board shorts × 3
 Linen shirt (open, breezy) × 2
 Quality rashguard × 1
 Cotton or linen tee × 3
 Lightweight adventure shorts × 1

LAYERS & EVENING

Linen trousers (eve) × 1
 Smart casual shirt (eve) × 1
 Lightweight long pants (jungle) × 1
 Swim trunks × 1
 Lightweight layer (AC interiors) × 1

SHOES

Sport sandal (Teva or Birkenstock) — beach and jungle
 Flip flop — beach only
 Trail shoe or sneaker — jungle tours and hiking
 Clean leather sandal — evening restaurant and town

ACCESSORIES

WARDROBE DETAILS

Quality polarised sunglasses
 Waterproof watch
 Waterproof dry bag

BAGS & EYEWEAR

Canvas day pack
 Lightweight belt
 UV-rated cap or hat

DRESS CODE — BY OCCASION

Beach & surf:

Town café/shop:

Sunset dinner:

Jungle tour:

Board shorts, rashguard and tee, sport sandal — fully casual

Shorts, linen shirt, clean sandal — neat beach casual

Linen trousers or clean shorts, shirt, leather sandal — elevated casual

Lightweight long pants, moisture-wicking tee, trail shoe — practical

OUTFIT INSPIRATION

SURF



Board shorts,
rashguard, sport sandal

TOWN



Linen shirt, shorts,
clean sandal

SUNSET



Linen trousers, shirt,
leather sandal

BEAUTY & TOILETRIES

What to Bring

Tropical humidity and intense UV require specific products.
Buy extra sunscreen locally — Costa Rican pharmacies stock good options and prices are fair.

HER BEAUTY BAG

SPF 50+ (reef-safe, non-negotiable)
Tinted SPF or BB cream
Waterproof mascara
Bronzer + illuminator
Tinted lip balm SPF
Light, fresh perfume
Coconut or argan hair oil
After-sun aloe gel

HIS GROOMING KIT

SPF 50+ reef-safe
Cologne (light, fresh)
Beard balm (humidity-resistant)
Lip balm SPF
Heavy-duty deodorant
Aloe after-sun gel
Hair paste (humidity-proof)
Face wipes

ESSENTIALS & SMART TRAVEL

TECH & PRACTICALITIES

US Type A/B adapter (Costa Rica uses US plugs)
Waterproof phone case
Reusable water bottle (insulated)
Insect repellent (DEET or Picaridin)

THE EXTRAS THAT MATTER

US dollars and colones
Offline maps (signal can be weak)
Travel insurance (including adventure sports)
Reef-safe sunscreen (law in some areas)

WHAT NOT TO PACK — EVER

Delicate or dry-clean-only fabrics — humidity and salt destroy them
Expensive or sentimental jewellery — sand and salt water are unforgiving
Heavy clothing of any kind — even evenings are warm in Guanacaste dry season
Dress shoes or heels — the town is sandy paths and beach, nothing else
Anything white that you love — red Guanacaste dust stains permanently

PACKING STRATEGY & CHECKLIST

Arriving in Tamarindo

Stay at a boutique property outside the main strip — quieter, more beautiful, same beach.

Rent a 4x4 or ATV — some of the best beaches require off-road access.

Wake up early at least once for the howler monkeys at sunrise over the jungle.

Book your surf lesson, zip-line, and whale-watching in advance — they fill up in season.

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Pura vida isn't a saying in Tamarindo. It's a practice.

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MASTER PACKING CHECKLIST

Print this page and tick each item as you pack.

HER CLOTHING

- ☐ Bikini sets × 3
- ☐ One-piece × 1
- ☐ Sundress × 3
- ☐ Board shorts × 1
- ☐ Linen trousers × 1
- ☐ Maxi coverup × 1
- ☐ Linen blouse × 2
- ☐ Joggers (jungle) × 1
- ☐ Rashguard × 1
- ☐ Slip dress × 1
- ☐ Sport sandal
- ☐ Flip flop
- ☐ Trail shoe
- ☐ Strappy flat
- ☐ Wide-brim hat
- ☐ Dry bag

HIS CLOTHING

- ☐ Board shorts × 3
- ☐ Linen shirt × 2
- ☐ Rashguard × 1
- ☐ Cotton tee × 3
- ☐ Adv. shorts × 1
- ☐ Linen trousers × 1
- ☐ Eve shirt × 1
- ☐ Long pants × 1
- ☐ Swim trunks × 1
- ☐ Light layer × 1
- ☐ Sport sandal
- ☐ Flip flop
- ☐ Trail shoe
- ☐ Leather sandal
- ☐ Waterproof watch
- ☐ Day pack

BEAUTY & GROOMING

- ☐ Reef-safe SPF 50+
- ☐ Tinted SPF
- ☐ Waterproof mascara
- ☐ Bronzer
- ☐ Tinted lip balm
- ☐ Perfume/cologne
- ☐ Hair oil
- ☐ Aloe after-sun
- ☐ Deodorant
- ☐ Beard balm
- ☐ Lip balm
- ☐ Face wipes
- ☐ Insect repellent
- ☐ Dry shampoo
- ☐ Power bank
- ☐ Waterproof phone case

EXTRAS & DOCS

- ☐ USD + colones
- ☐ US adapter
- ☐ Passport
- ☐ Travel insurance
- ☐ Insulated bottle
- ☐ Offline maps
- ☐ Adventure sport insurance
- ☐ Kindle / book
- ☐ Camera (waterproof)
- ☐ Hotel confirmations
- ☐ Pain reliever
- ☐ Plasters
- ☐ Reef-safe SPF
- ☐ Earplugs
- ☐ Eye mask
- ☐ Dry bag